

INTEGRITY RECORDS

CAUSING THE GLORY TO FALL

*A Worshiper's Guide to the Secret Place
Before the Stage*

*"God is spirit, and his worshipers must worship
in the Spirit and in truth."*

JOHN 4:24

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INTRODUCTION

The Space Before the Stage

There is a place every true worship leader learns to visit before there is ever a stage, a soundcheck, or an audience — a secret place, unwatched by anyone but God, where the heart gets settled before the hands ever touch an instrument. This book is about that place, and about the glory that has a way of following people who actually go there.

The word for that glory, throughout Scripture, is often *Shekinah* — the manifest, dwelling presence of God, tangible enough that it filled a tabernacle with cloud and a temple with smoke. It is not a metaphor for a good feeling in the room. It is the actual weight of God's presence choosing to show up among His people. This book asks a direct question: what actually invites that, and can it be pursued honestly, without turning it into a formula or a performance?

The glory was never something worked up. It was always something invited — by a people who had already met God before anyone else was watching.

None of what follows is a technique for manufacturing an atmosphere. It's an honest look at what Scripture actually shows happening in the room, the tent, and the temple, right before the glory fell — and what that means for anyone who leads worship today, whether in front of twelve people or twelve thousand.

CHAPTER ONE

What the Glory Actually Is

“Then the cloud covered the tent of meeting, and the glory of the LORD filled the tabernacle. Moses could not enter the tent of meeting because the cloud had settled on it, and the glory of the LORD filled the tabernacle.”

EXODUS 40:34-35

The glory of the Lord, in Scripture, is not decoration. It is described as something that fills a physical space so completely that even Moses — who had spoken with God face to face — could not enter. This is the Shekinah: God's dwelling presence, tangible, weighty, and unmistakably real to everyone present.

“When the priests withdrew from the Holy Place, the cloud filled the temple of the LORD. And the priests could not perform their service because of the cloud, for the glory of the LORD filled his temple.”

1 KINGS 8:10-11

What's worth noticing in both accounts is that the glory interrupted the normal function of the room. Moses couldn't enter. The priests couldn't perform their service. The glory didn't accessorize the activity already planned — it overwhelmed it. That is the caliber of presence this book is talking about, and it should immediately humble any conversation about “causing” it to fall, as though it were a light switch rather than a sovereign visitation.

Invited, not manufactured

And yet Scripture consistently shows this glory arriving in connection with worship — not randomly, and not disconnected from the posture of the people present. The tension this whole book sits inside is exactly this: the glory cannot be manufactured by technique, and yet it is not disconnected from how His people position themselves before Him. Causing the glory to fall, rightly understood, is never about control. It's about invitation.

REFLECTION

Have you ever mistaken atmosphere or emotion for the actual weight of God's presence — or the reverse?

What would change in your preparation if you treated the glory as genuinely invited rather than produced?

CHAPTER TWO

Losing Yourself Without Losing Your Mind

There is a kind of worship where a person appears, from the outside, to lose themselves entirely — abandoned, undone, no longer performing self-control in the ordinary sense. Scripture doesn't shy away from this. David danced before the Lord with such abandon that his own wife despised him for it, undignified in front of servants, caring more about the audience of One than the audience watching.

“David, wearing a linen ephod, danced before the LORD with all his might... Michal daughter of Saul watched from a window. And when she saw King David leaping and dancing before the LORD, she despised him in her heart.”

2 SAMUEL 6:14, 16

This is worth being precise about, because the title of this book uses a phrase — losing his mind — that could be misunderstood as chaos or theatrical excess. That is not what genuine abandon in worship looks like. David did not become incoherent or disordered. He became undignified by the world's standard, entirely because he had stopped performing for any audience except God. That is a very different thing than losing composure for its own sake, or manufacturing an emotional display because a room expects one.

Abandon in worship isn't the loss of your mind. It's the loss of every audience except One.

The difference between abandon and performance

- Genuine abandon happens whether or not anyone is watching; performance requires an audience to sustain it.
- Genuine abandon can look different every time, because it responds to God, not to a formula that reliably reads as passionate.
- Genuine abandon is not embarrassed by how it looks, but it is also not trying to look a particular way.

The goal is not composure at all costs, and it is not manufactured intensity either. It's an honest response to an actual encounter, whatever that response happens to look like in the moment — undignified, if that's what it costs, but never performed.

REFLECTION

Have you ever performed an emotional response in worship rather than actually having one?

What would it cost you, like David, to stop caring how your worship looks to the people watching?

CHAPTER THREE

Worship in Spirit and Truth

“Yet a time is coming and has now come when the true worshipers will worship the Father in the Spirit and in truth, for they are the kind of worshipers the Father seeks. God is spirit, and his worshipers must worship in the Spirit and in truth.”

JOHN 4:23-24

Jesus doesn't say the Father seeks worshipers who worship skillfully, or worshipers who worship at the right location. He says the Father seeks worshipers who worship in spirit and in truth — two words worth separating, because they correct two very different failures.

In spirit

Worship in spirit means worship that actually engages the human spirit, not merely the voice, the hands, or the performance of correct postures. It is possible to sing every lyric accurately and never once actually worship, because the spirit never engaged — the body went through motions the heart never joined.

And in truth

Worship in truth means worship rooted in what is actually real about God and about the worshiper, not in a performed version of either. Truth here cuts against pretense — singing words you don't believe, projecting an emotional state you're not actually in, or worshipping a version of God shaped more by the room's expectations than by who He actually is.

Spirit without truth becomes emotionalism. Truth without spirit becomes recitation. The Father seeks both, together, in the same worshiper.

This is the actual qualification for the kind of worshiper the Father seeks — not musicianship, not stage presence, not the size of the platform. Spirit and truth, together, in a person who has stopped performing either one.

REFLECTION

Where in your own worship has spirit been present without truth, or truth present without spirit?

What would worship in both, simultaneously, actually require you to lay down?

CHAPTER FOUR

The Secret Place Before the Stage

“But when you pray, go into your room, close the door and pray to your Father, who is unseen. Then your Father, who sees what is done in secret, will reward you.”

MATTHEW 6:6

Every worship leader eventually has to answer a question no audience can see the answer to: what happens before the stage? Not the rehearsal, not the soundcheck — the actual private, unwatched time spent with God, with no one to perform for and nothing to gain publicly from being there.

“He who dwells in the shelter of the Most High will abide in the shadow of the Almighty.”

PSALM 91:1

The secret place is not a preparation technique for a better set. It is where an actual relationship gets tended, the same relationship that will be the substance of whatever happens once the lights come up. A worship leader who skips this place and walks straight onto a stage is not necessarily faking anything — but they are drawing on reserves instead of a current, living encounter, and a congregation can often tell the difference even when they can't articulate why.

What the secret place actually contains

- Enough unhurried time that performance anxiety has a chance to settle before it's ever addressed by technique.
- Honest confession, not just preparation — bringing an actual current state before God rather than a curated one.
- Silence long enough to actually listen, not just talk, pray, and move on to the setlist.
- No agenda beyond the relationship itself — not rehearsing the night's flow, just being present with God.

What happens in the secret place is not a warm-up for the stage. It is the actual thing. The stage is just where it becomes visible.

REFLECTION

How much of your pre-stage time is actually secret-place encounter, versus rehearsal disguised as devotion?

What would it look like to protect real, unhurried time in the secret place before your next time leading worship?

CHAPTER FIVE

When Heaven Fills the Room

“The trumpeters and musicians joined in unison, as with one voice, to give praise and thanks to the LORD... Then the temple of the LORD was filled with a cloud, and the priests could not perform their service because of the cloud, for the glory of the LORD filled the temple of God.”

2 CHRONICLES 5:13-14

This is one of the clearest pictures in Scripture of the glory falling in direct connection with worship, and the detail worth sitting with is easy to miss: the musicians and singers were as one — not merely playing the same song, but unified in something deeper than arrangement. It was at that moment of genuine unity, not simply musical competence, that the cloud filled the house.

Unity is not the same as uniformity

This unity wasn't about everyone sounding identical. It was a team that had, apparently, come into agreement — the same devotion, the same posture, the same actual worship, converging rather than competing. A worship team full of individually skilled musicians who are not actually unified in spirit can produce excellent music and still never see the room fill the way this passage describes.

The glory didn't fall because the musicians were skilled. It fell because they had become, in that moment, one voice.

For a worship leader building or leading a team, this reframes what actually needs attention before a service. Rehearsal covers the notes. It rarely covers whether the people on the platform are genuinely unified in devotion, or simply coordinated in performance. Both are necessary. Only one of them is what 2 Chronicles actually credits with the glory falling.

REFLECTION

Is your team currently unified in devotion, or merely coordinated in performance?

What would it take to pursue the kind of unity 2 Chronicles 5 describes before your next rehearsal, not just during it?

CHAPTER SIX

Enthroned on Praise

“Yet you are holy, enthroned on the praises of Israel.”

PSALM 22:3

This verse, sometimes rendered “God inhabits the praises of His people,” describes something specific: praise functioning as a kind of throne God chooses to sit upon among His people. This is not superstition or magical thinking about music. It is a statement about where God has chosen to make Himself known and present in a particular way — in the praise of a people who actually mean it.

A throne, not a stage

The difference between a stage and a throne is worth naming plainly. A stage exists for an audience to watch a performer. A throne exists for a king to be honored and to reign. A worship leader who has confused the two will, without realizing it, begin building a stage even while using the language of worship — arranging the room, the set, and the moment around what will be seen and admired, rather than around who is actually being enthroned.

Every worship set builds something. The only question is whether it builds a stage for the leader or a throne for God.

Enthroning God on genuine praise doesn't require abandoning excellence, arrangement, or skill — the tabernacle and the temple were built with extraordinary craftsmanship, not carelessness. It requires excellence offered toward the right object. The same skill that could build a stage can, redirected, help build a throne.

REFLECTION

Honestly, in your last time leading worship, were you building a stage or a throne?

What would need to change — not necessarily in skill, but in direction — for your praise to function as a throne rather than a performance?

CHAPTER SEVEN

Chasing the Glory vs. Encountering God

There is a real danger in a book like this one, and it deserves to be named plainly: the moment “causing the glory to fall” becomes a technique to master rather than a relationship to steward, it curdles into exactly the kind of manipulation Scripture warns against. A worship leader can learn to manufacture an atmosphere that feels like glory — through dynamics, lighting, repetition, and vocal build — without God’s actual presence ever being the substance of what’s happening.

This is not a hypothetical concern. Any experienced worship leader has felt the pull toward engineering a moment rather than waiting on one, especially under pressure to deliver a consistent emotional experience week after week. The test worth applying honestly is simple: would this moment hold up in an empty room, with no one to impress and no arc to build toward? Or does it only work as spectacle, in front of people?

A manufactured atmosphere and an actual encounter can feel identical to an audience. They are never identical to the worshiper who knows the difference.

Guarding against chasing the feeling

- Notice when the goal has quietly shifted from encountering God to reproducing last week’s response.
- Be willing to lead a set that never builds to a peak, if that’s honestly where the room and the Spirit are.
- Return regularly to the secret place, where there’s no atmosphere to manufacture and no one watching the build.

The glory falling was never meant to be chased like a performance metric. It is invited, stewarded, and — most often — simply waited on, by people who have already met God before anyone else arrived.

REFLECTION

Where have you, even unintentionally, chased a feeling rather than pursued an actual encounter?

What would it look like to let a worship set be honest about where the room actually is, rather than engineering it toward a predetermined peak?

CLOSING WORD

Let the Glory Fall

Moses didn't build a formula and the cloud didn't fall because the tabernacle's craftsmanship earned it. The glory fell because a people had positioned themselves, in spirit and in truth, to actually receive what God was already willing to give. That is the whole of what this book has tried to say: the secret place, the unity, the abandon, the throne — none of it manufactures the glory. All of it simply makes room.

So go to the secret place before you ever reach the stage. Let your team become one voice before it becomes one sound. Worship in spirit and in truth, whether or not anyone is watching, and build a throne rather than a stage with whatever skill you've been given. That is not a technique for causing the glory to fall. It is simply what it has always looked like when it did.

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